

NovaTech Industries

Employee Handbook (Extended Edition)

Version 4.2 | Last Updated: August 2026

1. Welcome to NovaTech

Welcome to NovaTech Industries! We are thrilled to have you on board. Since our founding in 2010 in a small garage in San Francisco, NovaTech has grown into a global leader at the forefront of cloud infrastructure and enterprise software solutions. We have expanded our footprint across North America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific. Our success is built on the talent, dedication, and innovation of our team members. This handbook is designed to acquaint you with NovaTech and provide you with detailed information about working conditions, employee benefits, and the policies affecting your employment.

2. Company History & Mission

Our mission is to empower businesses to seamlessly transition and scale in the cloud. Over the past decade and a half, we have acquired three major subsidiaries and launched five flagship products, including NovaCloud and SecureSync. Our vision for the next five years focuses heavily on integrating AI-driven analytics into our core suite, helping clients not just store data, but understand it.

3. Core Values

Innovation: We challenge the status quo and push boundaries. We expect every employee to dedicate at least 5% of their time to exploring new ideas.

Integrity: We act with honesty and transparency in all we do. Trust is our most valuable currency.

Collaboration: We believe the best solutions come from working together. Silos are the enemy of progress.

Customer Success: Our customers' success is our success. We prioritize long-term partnerships over short-term gains.

4. Employment Policies

4.1 Equal Opportunity Employment

NovaTech is an equal opportunity employer. We do not discriminate on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable laws. We are committed to providing a workplace free of discrimination and harassment. We actively promote diversity through our hiring panels and inclusive workplace practices.

4.2 Onboarding and Probation

The first 90 days of employment at NovaTech are considered a probationary period. This timeframe allows both you and the company to determine if the role is a good fit. During this time, your manager will provide frequent feedback and establish your initial KPIs. Successful completion of the probationary period will be marked by a formal 90-day review.

4.3 Open Door Policy

We encourage open communication. If you have any concerns, questions, or suggestions, you are encouraged to discuss them with your direct manager. If the issue is not resolved, you may escalate it to Human Resources or higher management. Retaliation for raising a legitimate concern is strictly prohibited.

5. Workplace Guidelines

5.1 Office Hours and Attendance

Our standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM in your local time zone. We support flexible working arrangements, meaning you can adjust your start and end times in agreement with your manager. Core collaboration hours are between 10:00 AM and 3:00 PM. Employees must be available for meetings during these core hours. Frequent unexcused tardiness will result in disciplinary action.

5.2 Dress Code

NovaTech observes a "Dress for Your Day" policy. If you are interacting with clients or attending formal corporate events, business professional attire is expected. On regular office days, smart casual is appropriate. Please maintain a neat, clean, and professional appearance at all times. T-shirts with offensive slogans or excessively torn clothing are not permitted.

5.3 Remote Work

Depending on your role, you may be eligible for a hybrid or fully remote work arrangement. Remote employees are expected to maintain a secure, quiet, and ergonomically sound home office. NovaTech provides a one-time stipend of \$500 for home office setup. Remote workers must adhere to all data security protocols just as if they were in the physical office.

6. Employee Benefits & Well-being

6.1 Health Insurance

NovaTech offers comprehensive health, dental, and vision insurance plans for employees and their dependents. Coverage begins on the first day of the month following your start date. Detailed plan options and premiums are available in the HR portal.

6.2 Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

Mental health is just as important as physical health. Our EAP provides free, confidential, 24/7 counseling services for employees dealing with stress, anxiety, financial issues, or personal crises. You are entitled to up to 8 free therapy sessions per year.

7. Performance and Development

Performance reviews are conducted bi-annually, in June and December. These reviews are an opportunity to discuss your progress against your OKRs (Objectives and Key Results), set goals, and identify areas for professional development. We have an annual learning and development budget of \$1,000 per employee, which can be used for courses, certifications, or conferences relevant to your role. Merit increases and promotions are tied to performance and are evaluated exclusively during the December review cycle.

8. Termination of Employment

Employment at NovaTech is at-will in regions where applicable. Either the employee or the company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or advance notice. Upon resignation, employees are expected to provide a standard two-week notice to facilitate a smooth transition. Final paychecks will include compensation for any accrued but unused annual leave, subject to regional labor laws.